# CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
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## EDUCATION

**Stanford Graduate School of Business** *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
*Dissertation Committee:* Juliane Begenau, Hanno Lustig (co-chair), Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru (co-chair)

**Barcelona Graduate School of Economics**, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

**University of Hamburg** *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Climate Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing

## WORKING PAPERS

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
   - Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade NA 2025 PhD Student Award
2. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   - Winner of UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students, 2024 Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize

## WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
2. *From Markets to Meters: How Index Investing Affects Electricity Prices*
3. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

## PRESENTATIONS

AFA Annual Meeting* *2026*

SFS Cavalcade NA Conference, FIRS Conference, Four Corners/FMRC Conference on Indexing, *2025*
Carey Finance Conference*, Investment Company Institute, Northeastern University Finance Conference,
UIC Finance Conference[c], AFA Annual Meeting (2x Poster), Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

FIRS Conference, SoFiE Conference, SITE New Research in Asset Pricing[†], GRASFI Conference, *2024*
OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable
Financial Intermediation, FMA Conference, MFR Summer Session for Young Scholars (Poster),
UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo),
Citadel[c], Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, USC Marshall PhD Conference, MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster), *2023*
UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School

German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW) *2022*

*scheduled, [c]co-author, [†]declined/scheduling conflict

## OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

**The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt** *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

**University of Chicago** *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

**US Census Bureau** *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

**Princeton University** *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

**University of Hamburg** *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Stanford Graduate School of Business**

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| *Capital Markets and Institutional Investing*, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall | *2023, 2024* |
| *Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy*, TA to Amit Seru | *2022, 2023, 2024, 2025* |
| *Debt Markets*, TA to Darrell Duffie | *2021, 2022* |
| *Modeling for Investment Management*, TA to Steven Grenadier | *2023, 2024, 2025* |

**University of Hamburg**

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| *Macroeconomics 1 (UG)*, TA to Kristin Paetz | *2016* |

## SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

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| FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students | *2025* |
| SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award | *2025* |
| Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship | *2025-2026* |
| Nominated for the Gerald J. Lieberman Fellowship by Stanford GSB Finance Faculty | *2025* |
| Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI) | *2025* |
| American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting) | *2025* |
| FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students | *2024* |
| Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize | *2024* |
| GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award | *2024* |
| Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business | *2020–2025* |
| Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University | *2018–2020* |
| Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom | *2017–2018* |
| Undergraduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom | *2015–2017* |

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)
Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science

## BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

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| Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*) | *2011–2014* |
| Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant) | *2009–2011* |